

Newsletter, September 2026



SORTEE

Society for Open, Reliable, and Transparent
Ecology and Evolutionary Biology

Website: <https://www.sortee.org/>

Instagram: www.instagram.com/sortecoevo/

Twitter/X: [@sortecoevo](https://twitter.com/sortecoevo)

Bluesky: <https://bsky.app/profile/sortee.bsky.social>

LinkedIn: www.linkedin.com/company/sortee/

Slack: <https://sortee.slack.com/>

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Message from the Board of Directors

Dear SORTEE Community,

We would like to share an update about a Board transition and kindly invite you to get involved with SORTEE in 2027.

Board transition

Our colleague **Matthieu Paquet has officially stepped down from the SORTEE Board of Directors**. We would like to express our sincere gratitude to Matthieu for his many years of service, leadership, and contributions to SORTEE.

Matthieu has been involved with SORTEE since the Society's early days and has contributed across many areas of our work, including chairing the Conference Committee in 2023, chairing the Fundraising Committee in 2024, and as a member of several other committees. He has also served on the Board of Directors since 2024. His commitment and expertise have helped to shape SORTEE and strengthen our community, and we are very grateful for everything he has contributed.

Following Matthieu's resignation, the Board has appointed **Christian John**, SORTEE Treasurer and a member of the Advocacy Committee, to serve on the Board for the remainder of Matthieu's term, through **31 December 2026**.

We are grateful to Christian for taking on this role and look forward to his continued contribution to the Board in the months ahead.

Apply to volunteer in 2027 — Applications open October 1

We kindly invite you to consider volunteering for SORTEE in 2027!

Our mission – advancing research practices towards open, transparent, reliable, and equitable science – depends entirely on members who generously contribute their time. Volunteering also connects you with researchers around the world who share your interest in open science, helping to build new professional networks. Some say volunteering with SORTEE also helps when one feels lonely or isolated in academic life ♥

Applications will open on September 15th and close on October 31st, 2026. Apply through Google Form at <https://forms.gle/MFD1hNRxmTQkfGEh8>.

We are seeking nominees for **three types of positions**:

1. The **Board of Directors** (three-year term): *3 seats are available, including 1 seat reserved for a graduate student at the time of the election in November 2026.*
2. **Committee Chairs** (one-year term, can be renewed at the end of each year): *each committee has either one chair or two co-chairs. If you have already agreed to co-chair with someone, please say so in your application.*
3. **Committee Members** (one-year term, can be renewed at the end of each year): *the number of seats varies by committee.*

Please encourage your colleagues to [apply](#). If they are not a SORTEE member, they can sign up at sortee.org/join; note that there are free options with no questions asked.

Useful information about volunteering with SORTEE

- No experience required!
- We love diverse teams! People of all backgrounds are warmly encouraged to apply.
- You are welcome to apply for as many types of positions and committees that may interest you.

- You can apply for the same position in consecutive years (there is no limit on the number of years!) or a different one. We are always keen on new people to join the team!
- You will find a list of our 2026 volunteers at <https://sortee.org/people>. Feel free to message them on the SORTEE Slack or by email with questions.
- Have a look at the [2026 Committee guide](#) to give a sense of what volunteering involves.
- We are seeking applicants who can commit to the full term, but life happens – you may resign at any time by emailing the Board of Directors (board@sortee.org).
- Don't hesitate to reach out to contact@sortee.org with any questions.

Roles, tasks and time commitment

Board of Directors

The Board is a team of 9 that decides SORTEE's procedures, priorities, and personnel. A typical Board member spends 3–4 hours per month on a Zoom meeting, editing and commenting on documents, voting on society matters, and liaising with Committee Chairs.

Committee Chairs

One chair or two co-chairs coordinate their committee's work: they run meetings, organise asynchronous work, foster discussion and new initiatives, and make decisions for their committee. Expect 1–6 hours per month, depending on the committee and time of the year.

Committee Members

Members take on a specific role within their committee based on their preferences — we've found that committees work much better this way. Your workload depends largely on the role you choose, but you'll be able to take part in all of your committee's initiatives. Expect 1–3 hours per month, depending on the committee and time of the year.

Descriptions of each committee and its roles for 2027 are available in the application form at <https://forms.gle/MFD1hNRxmTQkfGEh8>.

Quotes from 2026 SORTEE volunteers

“



“Being a part of SORTEE has introduced me to a global community of hard-working, committed, creative, and overwhelmingly generous scientists who care about the same things I do. I’m constantly inspired to keep doing my best, knowing there is an entire community behind me who share the same goals!”
- Oakleigh Wilson, PhD student

“



“What excites me most about SORTEE is being part of a community of changemakers who are acutely aware of disparities in STEM capacity across regions, institutions, and demographics, and are motivated to address barriers to equitable participation in open science.”
- Dr. Swastika Issar

“



“I joined SORTEE in 2021 because I’m passionate about reliability and transparency in science. Through SORTEE, I’ve met a fantastic group of collaborators and friends who share that passion, which has been both energising and deeply rewarding.”
- Dr. Michael Bertram

We hope to see you on the SORTEE team in 2027!

Thank you to our 2026 volunteers and members

We would also like to take this opportunity to **express our sincere gratitude to all of our 2026 volunteers (<https://sortee.org/people/>) and members**. As a member-led society, everything we accomplish is made possible by people who generously contribute their time, energy, and expertise.

Thank you to everyone who has helped SORTEE grow, supported our community, organised events and activities, contributed to our committees, and advanced our mission throughout 2026.

We are truly grateful for every contribution.

The SORTEE conference is nearly here!

This year's **virtual & world-wide** SORTEE Conference will run continuously from **13th October 07:00 UTC to 14th October 09:15 UTC** to cover all time zones.

We are excited to announce our plenary speakers and titles of their talks:

- **Dr. Lauren Cadwallader** (Senior Open Research Manager, PLOS)

"Code Sharing in Practice: Lessons from Expanding a Publisher's Policy"

- **Dr. Tatsuya Amano** (Associate Professor, The University of Queensland)

"Is science open across languages?"

The complete conference program is now available [here](#)!

Don't forget to register! Registrations are open and will remain open until the conference, go ahead and [register today](#)!

Invite your colleagues! The conference is **FREE** for SORTEE members, and becoming a member can be free too! [Join us!](#) To join the mailing list and receive conference updates, click [here](#). To have an idea of what a SORTEE conference looks like, check the section "About SORTEE conferences".

Microgrants

This year we are introducing microgrants. Do you experience any barriers to attending the SORTEE Conference in October? Will a small financial contribution help you overcome this? Apply here: <https://forms.gle/p7YxXHv39ibwWQRq9>. Deadline: 30 September, 12 pm (UTC).

Volunteering Opportunities at the SORTEE Conference

Social Breaks

The conference committee is looking for **SORTEE members to help with the facilitation of two social breaks** scheduled during the conference:

- *Career-stage breakout rooms:* One social break ([October 13th, 11:30-11:55 AM UTC](#)) will involve breakout rooms by career stages. The goal is to foster connections, share experiences, and build community among conference attendees at similar career stages. **We are looking for SORTEE member(s) who are senior researchers** (with 10+ years of experience post PhD).
- *Language breakout rooms:* The other social break ([October 13th, 10:00-10:30 PM UTC](#)) will involve breakout rooms in different languages. The goal is to foster connection between conference attendees speaking the same native language, especially for people feeling less confident speaking in English. For each language room, **we are looking for at least one SORTEE member to facilitate a discussion about SORTEE, open science, or any other topic in their native language.** We already have facilitators for the following languages: English and French.

If you are interested and free for the dates and times above, please contact the conference committee at conference@sortee.org or directly on Slack. Your involvement is very important to make the conference a lively event, and it will be a fantastic opportunity to engage with other people in a relaxed setting. Anyone is welcome to participate, regardless of their level of involvement in SORTEE!

Technical Assistance

The conference committee is also looking for **volunteers to help with technical assistance during two sessions** scheduled during the conference:

- Hackathon 4 from [2:00 AM to 2:55 AM UTC on October 14th](#)
- Unconference 5 from [3:30 AM to 5:00 AM UTC on October 14th](#)

Volunteers will help by sending pre-written messages in the Zoom chat, monitoring the Zoom chat and the session's dedicated Slack channel for questions or issues, and recording the number of attendees midway through the session. If you are interested in volunteering for technical assistance, please email us at conference@sortee.org.

September SORTEE Code Club: Making (your own) academic websites with Quarto II

Wednesday 30.09.2026 (30 September, 2026)

15:00 - 16:30 UTC

Ever wanted to create your own website to disseminate your research, ideas, or code? Then this session is for you! Join us for a session where we show you how to create your own personal website with Quarto. Such websites are hosted via Github, and therefore free of charge, creating the perfect platform for all your (non)research outputs! Hope to see you there!

Note that this is a repeat of the May session, but still offers a good opportunity to keep learning and working on your website if you already attended the May session!

Code club zoom link:

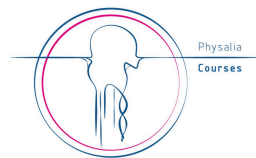
<https://us06web.zoom.us/j/81321425771?pwd=FO9oWqy0sihJNE8XfeiBj6SJJNwgab.1>

Add links to sortee.org on your website

If you have a website, please consider adding a link to sortee.org. The more websites that link to sortee.org, the higher our search engine rankings will be. This will help people searching on Google or other search engines find us more readily. Thanks!

SORTEE Fundraising Update

The generous support of our sponsors helps sustain SORTEE's core activities and services, including our annual conference, Workshop & Webinar Series, official preprint server ([EcoEvoRxiv](https://www.biorxiv.org/)), and meet-ups at in-person conferences. If you or any organization you know would be open to supporting SORTEE, please reach out to the current chair of the Fundraising Committee, Ruby Krasnow (ruby.krasnow@maine.edu). Additionally, if any SORTEE members are interested in organizing an in-person meetup or workshop and would like assistance finding or applying for funding to support the event, the Fundraising Committee is more than happy to help!



Winners of the 2026 SORTEE Commendation Award will be announced at SORTEE Annual conference in October!

We are delighted to share that we received 11 nominations for the 2026 SORTEE Commendation Awards!

The Awards Committee is currently reviewing the nominations, and we look forward to celebrating this year's awardees with our community.

The 2026 SORTEE Commendation Award **winners will be announced at the closing of the SORTEE Annual Conference on October 14, 2026!**

Thank you to all of our SORTEE members for nominations and for helping us recognise and celebrate work which advances SORTEE's mission of promoting open, transparent, and reliable science in ecology and evolutionary biology.

Submit to the SORTEE Newsletter

We welcome submissions to our newsletter. If you know of anything that SORTEE should or could announce (events, publications, announcements, ideas) in our newsletter, please let us know by sending an email to the newsletter editor, Tim Parker parkerth@whitman.edu with "SORTEE Newsletter" in the header (We do not advertise commercial services or products)

2026 SORTEE leadership team

Marija Purgar (Board Member, President, Awards Committee Chair)

Malgorzata (Losia) Lagisz (Board Member, President-elect)

Juliette Tariel-Adam (Board Member, Secretary)

Christian John (Board Member, Treasurer)

Ed Ivimey-Cook (Past-President, Advocacy Committee Co-Chair)

Michael Bertram (Board Member)

Stephanie Flaman (Board Member, Conference Committee Chair)

Ineta Kacergytė (Board Member)

Aidan Tan (Board Member)

Joel Pick (Advocacy Committee Co-Chair)

Brooke Long-Fox (DEI Committee Co-Chair)

Mark Young (DEI Committee Co-Chair)

Stefan Vriend (EcoEvoRxiv Committee Chair)

Saoirse Kelleher (Education and Outreach Committee Chair)

Ruby Krasnow (Fundraising Committee Chair)

Oakleigh Wilson (Media Committee Co-Chair)

Swastika Issar (Media Committee Co-Chair)

Natalie van Dis (Member Engagement Committee Chair)